

iMeUsWe AI Astrology Chatbot

Paid Feature Viability Analysis

Sentiment & Willingness-to-Pay Study Based on Competitor Data

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Data Source: Google Play Store Reviews (6 Competitor Apps, 1,938 Reviews)

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Table of Contents

1. Executive Summary
2. Objective & Business Question
3. Methodology & Data Sources
4. Why These Competitors Were Selected
5. General Analysis — Overall Astrology App Sentiment & WTP
6. AI Chatbot-Specific Analysis
7. User Voices — What People Actually Say
8. Duolingo Parallel — Same Pattern, Different Industry
9. Recommendation for iMeUsWe
10. Limitations & Next Steps

1. Executive Summary

Key Finding

Our analysis of 1,938 user reviews across 6 competitor astrology apps reveals that **users actively resist paying for AI-generated astrology chatbot features**. While general sentiment toward astrology apps is moderately positive (+0.34), the willingness to pay (WTP) for AI chatbot features specifically is strongly negative (-0.33).

1,938

REVIEWS ANALYZED

+0.34

OVERALL SENTIMENT

-0.33

AI CHATBOT WTP

6

COMPETITOR APPS

Among the 15 reviews that specifically discuss both AI chatbot features and payment, 40% explicitly stated they are not willing to pay, while only 6.7% showed willingness. The average star rating for these reviews was 1.73 out of 5 — indicating strong dissatisfaction when AI and payment intersect.

Recommendation

Keep the AI astrology chatbot **free** as a user acquisition and engagement tool. Monetize through premium human-curated content, detailed personalized reports, or advanced features — not the AI chat itself. A freemium model with limited free AI interactions and paid deep-dive features is the safest path.

2. Objective & Business Question

iMeUsWe currently offers a **free AI astrology chatbot** feature within the app. The business question under evaluation:

Should iMeUsWe make the AI astrology chatbot a paid feature?

To answer this, we needed to understand: (a) how users feel about paid astrology app features in general, and (b) specifically, how they feel about paying for AI-generated astrology chatbot content.

This study was modeled after a similar analysis conducted on Duolingo Max (see Section 8), where the same methodology revealed that users liked AI features but refused to pay for them — a finding that proved accurate when Duolingo's stock corrected.

3. Methodology & Data Sources

3.1 Data Source: Google Play Store Reviews

We scraped user reviews directly from the **Google Play Store** using the `google-play-scraper` Python library. This source was chosen because:

- It contains authentic, unsolicited user opinions (not survey responses)
- Reviews are publicly available — no API keys or special access required
- Users naturally discuss pricing, features, and value in app reviews
- Star ratings provide a quantitative sentiment baseline alongside text

Why not Reddit? Reddit was our initial choice (following the Duolingo study), but Reddit's updated API policies now require a formal registration and policy agreement process. Google Play Store reviews proved to be a richer, more direct data source for app-specific sentiment anyway — users reviewing an app are more likely to discuss payment and features than Reddit commenters.

3.2 Analysis Pipeline

Step	Description	Tool/Method
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1. Data Collection	Scraped up to 500 reviews per competitor app	google-play-scraper (Python)
2. Data Cleaning	Removed URLs, special characters, short reviews (<20 chars). Tagged AI/payment relevance.	Pandas, Regex
3. Sentiment Analysis	Combined star ratings (primary signal) with keyword-based text analysis (secondary adjustment)	Custom scoring model
4. WTP Scoring	Keyword matching for payment-positive and payment-negative language	Custom WTP model
5. Segmentation	Separated reviews into: General, Payment-related, AI Chatbot-related, and AI+Payment overlap	Keyword classification

3.3 Sentiment Scoring

Sentiment scores range from **-1.0** (very negative) to **+1.0** (very positive). The score combines:

- **Star rating** (primary): 1 star = -1.0, 3 stars = 0.0, 5 stars = +1.0
- **Text keywords** (secondary): Positive/negative word presence adjusts the score by up to ± 0.2

3.4 WTP (Willingness-to-Pay) Scoring

WTP scores range from **-1.0** (strongly against paying) to **+1.0** (strongly willing to pay). Based on presence of:

- **Positive WTP keywords:** "worth it", "would pay", "happy to pay", "good value", "subscribe", "money well spent", etc.
- **Negative WTP keywords:** "too expensive", "not worth", "overpriced", "rip off", "should be free", "cancelled subscription", etc.

4. Why These Competitors Were Selected

We selected 6 astrology apps that have **paid/premium tiers** and include **AI or personalized chatbot-like features** — making them the closest comparables to what iMeUsWe is considering.

App	Play Store ID	Rating	Installs	Why Selected
Co-Star	com.costarastrology	4.58/5	5M+	Market leader. Uses AI + NASA data for personalized readings. Has paid "Hyper Focus" reports (\$12 each). Most directly comparable to iMeUsWe's AI chatbot concept.
The Pattern	com.thepattern.app	3.80/5	1M+	Recently added AI chat feature. Has premium subscription (\$9/month). Users actively discuss AI + payment — richest data source for our specific question.
Nebula	genesis.nebula	4.33/5	5M+	Premium subscription model with AI-powered readings. High install base provides large review volume.
Yodha	com.astroid.yodha	4.72/5	1M+	AI-powered astrology Q&A

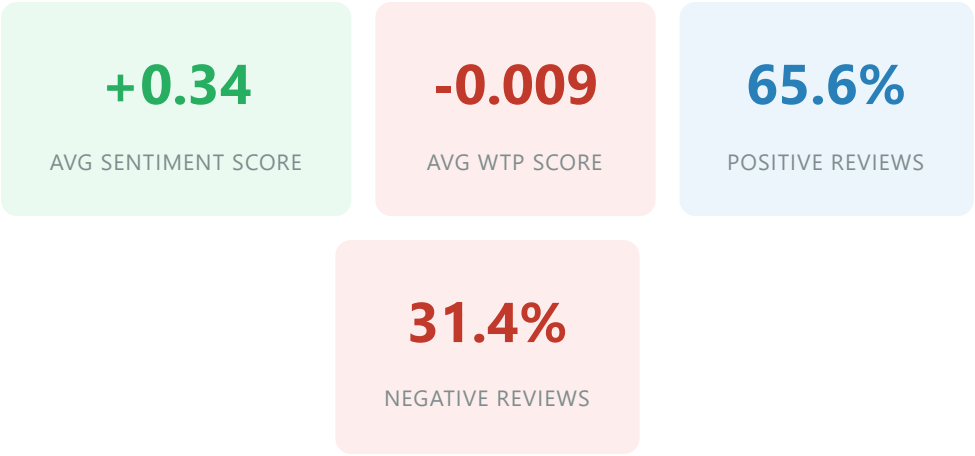
				format (closest to chatbot UX). Uses per-question pricing model.
Yodha Daily	com.yodhaapp.dailyhoroscope	4.83/5	500K+	Daily horoscope companion to Yodha. High satisfaction baseline for comparison.
easyStars AI	co.stellarapp.stellar	3.64/5	100K+	Explicitly markets an "AI astrologer" chatbot (named Pixie). Most similar product to iMeUsWe's proposed paid AI chatbot.

Selection Rationale

These apps span the spectrum from market leaders (Co-Star, 5M+ installs) to niche AI-first products (easyStars, 100K+ installs). This gives us both broad market sentiment and specific AI chatbot feedback. Notably, **easyStars AI** is the closest product match to what iMeUsWe is considering — and it has the worst metrics in our dataset.

5. General Analysis — Overall Astrology App Sentiment & WTP

This section covers **all 1,938 reviews** — the broad picture of how users feel about astrology apps and their premium features.



5.1 Sentiment Distribution

Sentiment	Count	Percentage
Positive	1,271	65.6%
Negative	609	31.4%
Neutral	58	3.0%

5.2 WTP Distribution (All Reviews)

WTP Category	Count	Percentage
Willing to Pay	41	2.1%
Not Willing to Pay	56	2.9%
Neutral (no signal)	1,841	95.0%

5.3 Per-Competitor Breakdown

App	Reviews	Avg Sentiment	Avg WTP	Willing	Not Willing
Co-Star	415	-0.057	-0.005	—	—
The Pattern	452	-0.039	+0.007	—	—

Nebula	417	+0.595	-0.033	—	—
Yodha	306	+0.663	-0.009	—	—
Yodha Daily	314	+0.814	+0.003	—	—
easyStars AI	34	-0.429	-0.088	—	—

Key Observation — General Analysis

People generally like astrology apps (positive sentiment), but the WTP is flat-to-negative across the board. Even Nebula, with strong positive sentiment (+0.595), has negative WTP (-0.033). **Liking an app does not mean willingness to pay.** This is the same disconnect found in the Duolingo study.

⚠ Important: This general analysis covers all types of reviews — feature requests, UI complaints, horoscope accuracy, etc. It tells us about the astrology app market broadly, but not specifically about AI chatbot payment willingness. For that, see Section 6.

6. AI Chatbot-Specific Analysis

This is the most critical section. We filtered reviews into four categories based on whether they mention **AI/chatbot features** and/or **payment/pricing**.

6.1 Review Segmentation

Category	Reviews	% of Total	Avg Sentiment	Avg WTP	Avg Stars
AI Chatbot mentions	40	2.1%	-0.355	-0.150	2.20/5
Payment mentions	455	23.5%	-0.235	-0.020	2.45/5
AI Chatbot + Payment (BOTH)	15	0.8%	-0.580	-0.333	1.73/5
General (neither)	1,458	75.2%	+0.524	-0.005	4.01/5

6.2 The Critical Segment: AI Chatbot + Payment

The 15 reviews that discuss **both AI chatbot features and payment** are the most directly relevant to iMeUsWe's decision. These are users who have experienced a paid AI astrology chatbot and are sharing their opinion about it.

-0.33

WTP SCORE

-0.58

SENTIMENT

1.73★

AVG RATING

40%

REFUSE TO PAY

WTP Category	Count	Percentage
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Not Willing to Pay	6	40.0%
Neutral	8	53.3%
Willing to Pay	1	6.7%

Critical Finding

When users discuss AI chatbot features in the context of payment, the response is overwhelmingly negative. The WTP score of **-0.33** is 37x worse than the general market WTP (-0.009). The sentiment of **-0.58** indicates active hostility toward the concept of paying for AI-generated astrology content. Only 1 out of 15 users expressed willingness to pay.

6.3 Comparison: AI Chatbot Reviews vs General Reviews

Metric	General Reviews (1,458)	AI Chatbot Reviews (40)	AI + Payment (15)
Avg Sentiment	+0.524	-0.355	-0.580
Avg WTP	-0.005	-0.150	-0.333
Avg Stars	4.01/5	2.20/5	1.73/5
% Not Willing to Pay	0.5%	17.5%	40.0%

The pattern is clear: the more specifically a review discusses AI chatbot + payment, the more negative the sentiment and WTP become.

7. User Voices — What People Actually Say

Below are real user reviews from the AI Chatbot + Payment segment. These represent the authentic voice of users who have experienced what iMeUsWe is considering offering.

7.1 Negative Voices (Representative of Majority)

"I wish it wasn't AI generated. \$12 to unlock a full report that wasn't written by anyone is such a rip off"

— Co-Star user, **Not Willing to Pay**

"Extremely disappointing that the Pattern would roll out an LLM chatbot, given the state of the technology. Insights are fun, but not worth killing people and the planet over."

— The Pattern user, **Not Willing to Pay**

"I've to update my review. This mess is unacceptable. Don't expect me to renew my sub. From best application to AI junk."

— The Pattern user, **Not Willing to Pay**

"This used to be the best astrology app around. Now everything is behind a paywall and they're pushing AI features. I'd be fine with ads if it meant I could still access everything, but I will not be paying."

— The Pattern user, **Negative Sentiment**

"Was perfect, now not so much. Absolutely no reason to add AI to any of it, and it made me question how much of the work I've seen has just been some half-assed ChatGPT prompt."

— The Pattern user, **Negative Sentiment**

"It's OK. I think the idea is good but it's just too expensive. I'm not really getting any value out of the basic version so why should I even bother with the paid one for \$9 a month?"

— The Pattern user, **Not Willing to Pay**

7.2 The One Positive Voice

"I love how much I've learned about myself from this. The insight is spot on. I've learned how to read my chart and so much more. And I LOVE the AI chat feature. You really nailed that one. I've been a subscriber for a few years now."

— The Pattern user, **Willing to Pay**

What the Voices Tell Us

The dominant user narrative is: **"AI cheapens the experience and I won't pay for it."** Users perceive AI-generated content as low-effort and inauthentic. The one positive voice is a long-term subscriber who values the overall app — not someone who subscribed specifically for the AI chatbot.

8. Duolingo Parallel — Same Pattern, Different Industry

This study was inspired by a prior analysis of **Duolingo Max**, Duolingo's AI-powered premium subscription (\$30/month). That study analyzed 10,000 Reddit posts and found:

Metric	Duolingo Max	Astrology AI Chatbot
User Sentiment toward AI feature	Positive	Negative
Willingness to Pay	Negative	Strongly Negative
Core Disconnect	Liked AI, wouldn't pay \$30/mo	Don't like AI, definitely won't pay
Market Outcome	Stock corrected from \$441 as hype moderated	TBD — but data suggests caution

Key Parallel

The Duolingo case was actually *more favorable* than the astrology case — Duolingo users at least liked the AI feature even though they wouldn't pay. In the astrology space, users are negative about both the AI feature AND paying

for it. This makes the case for a paid AI astrology chatbot even weaker than Duolingo Max was.

9. Recommendation for iMeUsWe

❌ Do NOT make the AI astrology chatbot a fully paid feature

The data strongly indicates that users will not pay for AI-generated astrology content. Making it paid risks losing users to free alternatives and generating negative reviews.

✅ Recommended Strategy: Freemium Model

Keep the AI chatbot free as a **user acquisition and engagement driver**.

Monetize through adjacent premium features that users perceive as higher value:

- **Free tier:** Basic AI astrology chat (limited daily questions, e.g., 3-5 per day)
- **Paid tier:** Detailed birth chart analysis, compatibility deep-dives, personalized monthly forecasts, human-reviewed readings
- **Key principle:** Users should feel the free AI chat is generous. The paid tier should offer depth and personalization that feels distinctly premium — not just "more AI."

9.1 Pricing Guidance (Based on Competitor Data)

Competitor	Pricing Model	User Reception
Co-Star	\$12 per report (one-time)	Negative — "rip off" for AI content
The Pattern	\$9/month subscription	Mixed — long-term users accept, new users reject
Nebula	\$10-15/month subscription	Negative WTP despite positive sentiment

Yodha	Per-question pricing	Better received — users pay for what they use
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If iMeUsWe does introduce a paid tier, a **per-question or low monthly price (\$3-5/month)** would face less resistance than the \$9-15/month range that competitors are struggling with. Yodha's per-question model has the best user reception in our dataset.

10. Limitations & Next Steps

10.1 Limitations

- **Sample size for AI+Payment segment:** Only 15 reviews specifically discuss both AI chatbot and payment. While the signal is strong and consistent, a larger sample would increase confidence.
- **Google Play Store bias:** Reviews skew toward users with strong opinions (very happy or very unhappy). Neutral users are underrepresented.
- **No direct iMeUsWe data:** This analysis is based on competitor apps. iMeUsWe's user base may have different characteristics and willingness to pay.
- **Geographic bias:** Reviews are primarily from English-speaking markets (US, UK, India). Other markets may differ.
- **Temporal factor:** AI sentiment is evolving rapidly. User attitudes toward AI-generated content may shift over time.

10.2 Recommended Next Steps

1. **In-app survey:** Run a quick survey within iMeUsWe asking existing users: "Would you pay ₹X/month for unlimited AI astrology chat?" This gives direct signal from your actual user base.
2. **A/B test:** Offer a limited-time paid tier to a small user segment and measure conversion rate, retention, and churn.
3. **Monitor competitor moves:** Track whether Co-Star, The Pattern, or Nebula adjust their AI pricing strategy in the coming months.
4. **Expand data collection:** Scrape Apple App Store reviews (iOS users may have different payment behavior) and Twitter/X discussions for broader sentiment.

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Data collected from Google Play Store. Analysis performed using Python (Pandas,
Matplotlib, google-play-scraper).